Executive Producer Stephen Broussard breaks down the filming process: "We designed this entire sequence where Iron Man and Rhodey are running up and down these cranes trying to get to the president of the United States and Pepper Potts to save them. Meanwhile, all around them, an enormous battle is raging between thirty Iron Man suits and these human beings enhanced by Extremis. So Tony and Rhodey are fighting their way through this huge battle—sometimes in a suit, sometimes not in a suit.

"The first thing we did, like we do with a lot of our finales, is what's called a previs—which is a rough, animated storyboard version of it, where you just tell the best version of the story you can. That's where you play, and you make the action beats as cool as they can be, and you just kind of go nuts and make a little mini-movie, a mini-cartoon—to make sure it's something you think is awesome and befitting the finale of your movie.

"We spent a lot of time working on that with Shane Black—a lot of time standing around models with little dolls, running up and down stairs. Planning the beats, planning the storytelling, just getting it into a shape that made sense at a story level. Making sure we had that right.

"And then, once you have a rough version of that, you say, 'How the heck are we going to do this?' And you start breaking it down into the little pieces: stairs here, a catwalk there, concrete there. You start saying: What are we going to build, what are we gonna shoot on location at the cranes, what's just pure green screen? What's pure CG, because it's all suit-and-sky stuff? It's really a collage of all these little disparate pieces."

